



ASSIGNMENT (30%)

TRIMESTER MARCH/APRIL 2026

LAE1113 – ACADEMIC ENGLISH

ASSIGNMENT: ARGUMENTATIVE ESSAY (30%)

CLO1: Demonstrate the ability to produce an effective synthesis essay

General guidelines:

1. Students will work in groups of **3 – 4 people**.
2. A chosen topic needs to be narrowed down. For example:
Topic: Capital punishment
*Thesis: Capital punishment **should not** be implemented because of several reasons.*
*Thesis statement: Capital punishment **should not** be implemented **because it is against moral values, it does not act as a deterrent, and it may claim innocent lives.***
3. Students must select **three (3) to five (5) articles** (articles from published sources like journals, books, magazines, newspapers and others) which are published from **2020 to 2026**.
4. Students need to synthesise and paraphrase information from the articles to support their thesis. **Each body paragraph must include 1-2 citations, formatted in APA style.** Citations should primarily appear in the body paragraphs where evidence is discussed. While citations are not typically required in the introduction and conclusion, if students choose to include them, they should ensure that they are used appropriately and contribute meaningfully to the overall argument.
5. Students must obtain topic approval from the lecturer prior to submitting their outline in Week 7.
6. Students are encouraged to submit an outline by **Week 7** for checking purposes, but the submissions carry **NO MARKS**.
7. The essay length is **3-4 pages**; excluding the title, reference and other pages. All pages must be **justified and numbered**.
8. The font is **Times New Roman, size 12, and double spacing**.
9. The front page should include the name of the University, the title of the Essay, student's name, ID no. and section no., and the name of the lecturer.
10. A template of the front page and the page for the essay will be put up online as reference. Students should adhere to the specifications given.
11. The essay will go through submission for plagiarism similarity index and AI- generated content. Please refer to **Plagiarism and AI-Generated Content Submission Guidelines**.
12. The submission deadline is **Week 9**.

ESSAY TOPICS:

1. **Gender Equality in the Workplace**
Question: Are companies making adequate efforts to promote gender equality in modern workplaces and leadership roles?
2. **Banning Plastic Bags**
Question: Should the use of single-use plastic bags be banned worldwide to combat environmental degradation?
3. **Grading System**
Question: Does the current grading system adequately reflect student capabilities and learning in today's education?
4. **Artificial Intelligence**
Question: Will the integration of AI in daily life create more challenges than benefits for humanity by 2030?
5. **Screen Time and Mental Health**
Question: Should there be limits on screen time for teenagers?
6. **Self-Driving Cars**
Question: Should self-driving cars be allowed on public roads?
7. **Veganism and the Environment**
Question: Should people be encouraged to adopt a vegan lifestyle to protect the environment?
8. **Animal Rights**
Question: Should owning exotic animals as pets be made illegal?
9. **Human Trafficking**
Question: Is enough being done globally to stop human trafficking?
10. **Nuclear Weapons**
Question: Should global disarmament of nuclear weapons be enforced to ensure world peace?
11. **Prison Reform**
Question: Should prison systems prioritize rehabilitation over punishment in the 21st century?
12. **Cancel Culture**
Question: Is cancel culture damaging public discourse and freedom of expression?
13. **Gender Identity and Public Policy**
Question: Should governments legally recognise non-binary and diverse gender identities beyond the traditional male/female categories?
14. **Artificial Intelligence and Employment**
Question: Should AI and robots replace human jobs in industries where automation is possible?

15. **Digital Privacy**

Question: Should governments implement stronger laws to protect citizens' digital privacy against mass surveillance?

16. **Mental Health Awareness**

Question: Should mental health education be mandatory in all schools to reduce stigma and promote well-being?

17. **Virtual Reality in Education**

Question: Can virtual reality or metaverse replace traditional classroom learning effectively in the next decade?

18. **Online Censorship**

Question: Is online censorship necessary to maintain social harmony, or does it threaten free speech?

19. **Remote Work**

Question: Is remote work a sustainable model for the future workforce post-pandemic?